The Frog Prince Continued

By Jon Scieszka

NARRATOR: The Princess kissed the frog, he turned into a prince and they lived happily ever after. Well, let's just say they lived sort of happily for a long time. Okay, so they weren't so happy. In fact, they were miserable.

PRINCESS: Stop sticking your tongue out like that.

PRINCE: How come you never want to go down to the pond anymore?

NARRATOR: The Prince and Princess were so unhappy. They didn't know what to do.

INTRODUCTION

And they lived happily ever after . . .This is where most fairy tales end. The prince and princess marry and ride off into the sunset to begin their new life together as husband and wife, a life full of promise, romance, and above all, love. But no one has ever told us how this is supposed to happen, or why it succeeds if it does. In The Frog Prince Continued by Jon Scieszka, the truth behind happily ever after is revealed -- warts and all. (CROAK)

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PRINCESS: I would prefer that you not hop around on the furniture. And it might be nice if you got out of the castle once in a while to slay a dragon or giant or whatever.

NARRATOR: The Prince didn't feel like going out and slaying anything. He just felt like running away. But then he reread his book. And it said right there at the end of his story: "They lived happily ever after. The End." So he stayed in the castle and drove the Princess crazy. Then one day, the Princess threw a perfectly awful fit.

PRINCESS: First you keep me awake all night with your horrible, croaking snore. Now I find a lily pad in your pocket. I can't believe I actually kissed your slimy frog lips. Sometimes I think we could both be better off if you were still a frog.

NARRATOR: That's when the idea hit him. The Prince thought . . .

PRINCE: Still a frog . . .Yes! That's it!

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NARRATOR: And he ran off into the forest, looking for a witch who could turn him back into a frog. The Prince hadn't gone far when he ran into just the person he was looking for.

PRINCE: Miss Witch, Miss Witch. Excuse me, Miss Witch. I wonder if you could help me?

WITCH 1: Say, you're not looking for a princess to kiss are you?

PRINCE: Oh, no. I've already been kissed. I'm the Frog Prince. Actually, I was hoping you could turn me back into a Frog.

WITCH: Are you sure you're not looking for a beautiful sleeping princess to kiss and wake up?

PRINCE: No, no -- I'm the Frog Prince.

WITCH: That's funny. You don't look like a frog. Well, no matter. If you're a prince, you're a prince. And I'll have to cast a nasty spell on you. I can't have any princes waking up Sleeping Beauty before the hundred years are up.

NARRATOR: The Prince didn't stick around to see which nasty spell the witch had in mind. He ran deeper into the forest until he came to a tiny cottage where he saw another lady who might help him.

PRINCE: Miss Witch, Miss Witch. Excuse me, Miss Witch. I wonder if you could help me. I'm a prince and---"

WITCH 2: Eh? What did you say? Prince?

PRINCE: No, I mean, yes. I mean, no, I'm not the prince looking for Sleeping Beauty. But, yes, I'm the Frog Prince. And I'm looking for a member of your profession who can turn me back into a frog so I can live happily ever after.

WITCH: Frog Prince, you say? That's funny. I thought frogs were little green guys with webbed feet. Well, no matter: If you're a prince, you're a prince. And I can't have any princes rescuing Snow White. Here- eat the rest of this apple.

NARRATOR: The Prince, who knew his fairy tales (and knew a poisoned apple when he saw one), didn't even stay to say, "No Thank you." He turned and ran deeper into the forest. Soon he came to a strange-looking house with a witch outside.

PRINCE: Ahem. Miss Witch, Miss Witch. Excuse me, Miss Witch. I wonder if you could help me? I'm the Frog-

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WITCH 3: If you're a frog, I'm the King of France.

PRINCE: No, I'm not a frog. I'm the Frog Prince. But I need a witch to turn me back into a frog so I can live happily ever after, can you do it?"

WITCH: *(eyeing the Prince and licking her lips)* Why, of course, dearie. Come right in. Maybe I can fit you in for lunch.

NARRATOR: The Prince stopped on the slightly gummy steps. Something about this house seemed very familiar. He broke off a corner of the windowsill and tasted it. Gingerbread.

PRINCE: I hope you don't mind my asking, Miss Witch. But do you happen to know any children by the name of Hansel of Gretel?

WITCH: Why yes, Prince darling, I do. I'm expecting them for dinner.

NARRATOR: The Prince who, as we said before, knew his fairy tales, ran as fast as he could deeper into the forest. Soon he was completely lost. He saw someone standing next to a tree. The Prince walked up to her, hoping she wasn't a witch, for he'd quite had his fill of witches.

PRINCE: Madam. I am the Frog Prince. Could you help me?"

FAIRY GODMOTHER: Gosh, do you need it. You are the worst-looking frog I've ever seen.

PRINCE: I am not a frog. I am the Frog Prince and I need someone to turn me back into a frog so I can live happily ever after.

FAIRY GODMOTHER: Well, I'm on my way to see a girl in the village about going to a ball, but I suppose I could give it a try. I've never done frogs before, you know.

NARRATOR: And with that the Fairy Godmother waved her magic wand and turned the Prince into a beautiful carriage. The Prince couldn't believe his rotten luck. The sun went down. The forest got spookier. And the Prince became more and more frightened.

PRINCE: Oh, what an idiot I've been. I could be sitting at home with the Princess, living happily ever after. But instead, I'm stuck here in the middle of this stupid forest, turned into a stupid carriage. Now I'll probably just rot and fall apart and live unhappily ever after.

NARRATOR: The Prince thought these terrible, frightening kinds of thoughts (and a few worse- too awful to tell), until far away in the village the clock struck midnight. The carriage instantly

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turned back into his former Prince self and ran by the light of the moon until he was safe inside his own castle.

PRINCESS: Where have you been? I've been worried sick. You're seven hours late. Your dinner is cold. Your clothes are a mess.

PRINCE: The Prince looked at the Princess who had believed him when no one else in the world had, the Princess who had actually kissed his slimy frog lips. The Princess who loved him.

NARRATOR: The Prince kissed the Princess. They both turned into frogs. And they hopped off happily ever after. *(CROAK)*

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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